

What is the Moon made of?

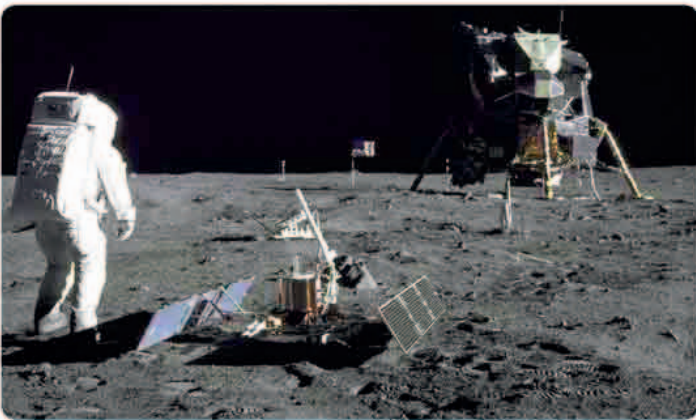
The Moon is made of a mixture of rocks and metals. About 4.5 billion years ago, a small planet smashed into the Earth. Lots of chunks broke off and blasted into space. The Moon was made when some of these joined together again.

Solid rock

The mantle is a layer that starts 30 miles (50 km) below the Moon's surface. It is mainly made of solid rock.

Walking on the Moon

The Moon is the only place aside from the Earth where human beings have walked. From 1969 to 1972, a total of 12 astronauts landed on the Moon. They did experiments, took photographs, and brought back samples of rock. This picture is from the very first Moon landing in 1969.



Cratered crust

The Moon's outside, or crust, is made of hard rock. Its surface is covered in very fine, gray dust, and is also scarred with craters. These were made by asteroids that crashed into the Moon during its early life.